

Dry-Aged Pork Tomahawk Dinner

Sunday 27 September 2026 · Serves 3 · Target service 6:00 pm, floating 5:45–6:15 · Restrained French bistro register

Menu

- Reverse-seared dry-aged Gooralie pork tomahawk, with crisp-rind belly and crackling
- Sharp cider–shallot jus
- Potato purée
- Shaved fennel and Granny Smith salad
- Charred hispi cabbage

Meal Workflow

Critical path

Loin pull at 130°F / 54°C → 8-min rest → sear → rest and safety check → carve → serve. Service floats with the loin's exit from the oven (E+0); everything after exit is keyed to E.

Failure prioritization

Do not delay the loin's rest, sear or safety check for anything. The purée absorbs timing drift (loosen with warm milk). The jus rewarms and the salad waits undressed. If the belly rind has not puffed by E+18, serve the loin and send the belly after. The crackling is optional and can be dropped.

Oven sequencing

The oven holds 225°F / 107°C for the loins, belly pieces and finished crackling; there are no temperature changes. At E+0, switch the oven off, crack the door for 1 min, then put the plates in to warm; the crackling stays in with them.

Heat allocation and parallel work

Heat source	Job
Oven	Loins and belly low roast from 4:45; crackling hold; plate warming after E+0
Induction 1	Jus build (2:30–3:20); rewarm from E+0
Induction 2	Purée (4:40–5:20); contingency reheat at E+10
Tiger	Purée hold from 5:20 (planned max 60 min, designed)
Binchotan	Lit 4:55; loin sear only, from E+8
Outdoor gas burner 1	Hispi, from E+3
Outdoor gas burner 3	Crackling 4:00–4:25 (optional); belly crisping from E+0

Runs in parallel after E+0: the loin rest, belly crisping, hispi and jus rewarm. The sear (E+8) cannot overlap the carve or the jus finish; both wait for the loin.

T-minus timeline — before the loin leaves the oven (nominal service 6:00)

Time	Action
Sat (done)	Belly split from the loins; rind taken off the loin fat caps; belly cut into ~8 cm pieces, rind into ~3 cm strips. Belly + rind (631 g) salted with 5 g, rind-up, uncovered overnight. Loins unsalted, loosely covered.
T-255 (1:45)	Weigh the loins; salt at 0.8%. Refrigerate uncovered on a rack (3-hr brine).
T-210 (2:30)	Build the jus (~50 min).
T-150 (3:30)	Jus strained, cooled in a shallow container, refrigerated.
T-120 (4:00)	Optional: crisp the rind strips on burner 3 (15–25 min). Pour the rendered fat into a bowl for the belly.
T-105 (4:15)	Preheat the oven to 225°F / 107°C. Pork goes in once the oven reads temperature.
T-80 (4:40)	Purée potatoes on (~40 min to Tiger).
T-75 (4:45)	Loins and belly pieces in, fridge-cold; crackling on the same rack. Probe in the loin eye, alarm 127°F / 53°C.
T-65 (4:55)	Light the binchotan (ready by 5:25; holds for hours). Quarter and season the hispi.
T-55 (5:05)	Shave the fennel and shallot, make the dressing; chill undressed.
T-40 (5:20)	Purée into the Tiger on Keep Warm (ceiling 6:20; contingency trigger 6:00).
5:25–5:55	Exit window. Pull the loin at 130°F / 54°C = E+0. Record total oven time.

After the loin leaves the oven (E+)

Time	Action
E+0	Loin onto a rack, uncovered, probe still in — 8-min rest. Oven off, plates in (crackling stays in). Jus on very low. Belly rind-down in the reserved fat on burner 3 (12–18 min).
E+3	Hispi on burner 1 (9–14 min).
E+8	Reading #2, remove probe. Sear per the reading-#2 gate (4–6 min). Reading #3 at the stop; record contact time.
E+10	Cut the apple, dress the salad (hold ≤10 min).
E+12–18	Hispi and belly finish; hold both uncovered.
E+14	Loin rests uncovered on a rack (≥4 min).
E+15	Check the purée; loosen with warm milk 10 ml at a time if tight.
E+16	Jus off heat; whisk in 15 g cold butter.
E+18	Reading #4 (≥145°F / 63°C) + plate temperature. Carve. Adjust the jus against an end slice.
E+20	Plate: purée, hispi, loin, belly and crackling beside, jus around the loin, salad last. Serve.

If the plating window slips, the loin crust and the belly rind soften first.

Arithmetic check

- **Earliest exit 5:25 (serve 5:45):** purée hold 25 min; loin brine 3 hr; hispi hold 3–8 min; belly hold 2–8 min. Passes.
- **Latest exit 5:55 (serve 6:15):** purée hold 55 min (within 60); binchotan lit 68 min at the sear (burns for hours). Passes.
- **Beyond the band:** if the loin is still in the oven at the trigger (20 min before the Tiger ceiling — 6:00), the purée leaves the Tiger, is covered, and is reheated on induction 2 at E+10. The 60-min hold is never extended.

Holding chain

Component	Hold	Max hold	Drift	Corrective
Jus	Refrigerated; rewarmed on very low	Rewarm ≤20 min	Tightens	Thin with unsalted stock
Purée	Tiger Keep Warm	60 min (designed)	Stiffens	Warm milk, 10 ml at a time
Crackling	Rack in the 225°F oven, then the switched-off oven	Until plating (designed)	Softens in humidity	1 min rind-down in the belly pan
Salad	Chilled undressed; dressed E+10	Dressed ≤10 min	Wilts	Drain; serve
Hispi	Uncovered, warm	10 min	Softens	None; serve
Belly	Uncovered on a rack	10 min	Rind softens	Keep away from the jus
Loin	Uncovered rack	Prescribed rests only	—	—

Meal balance

Richness comes from the loin fat, the belly, the crackling and the purée. Acid does three distinct jobs: cider vinegar gives the jus depth and edge, lemon gives the salad a palate reset, and a little lemon may correct the hispi. Sweetness from the apple family (medium-dry cider, Granny Smith) is controlled by a tart apple and the full vinegar reserve. Temperature runs from hot pork and hispi, through warm purée, to the cold salad. Texture: crust, crackling and crisp rind, silky purée, raw crunch, charred leaf. No chilli.

To confirm after the cook

The 130°F / 54°C pull and four-point series; the reading-#2 sear thresholds; the 40–70 min oven band at 3.5 cm; the belly rind-down crisp (12–18 min) after an overnight dry salt; the crackling method and oven hold; the 60-min Tiger hold; the hispi timings.

Shared Prep

Ingredient	Total	Breakdown
Shallots, peeled	90 g / 3¼ oz	70 g sliced → Jus · 20 g paper-thin → Salad
Lemon, juiced	1 large (~25 ml)	20 ml → Salad · up to 5 ml → Hispi (reserve)
Unsalted butter	105 g / 3¾ oz	10 g + 15 g cold → Jus · 80 g → Purée
Rendered pork fat	From the crackling	Crackling → Belly crisping (use neutral oil if the crackling is dropped)

Shopping List

Ingredient	Total	Pork	Jus	Purée	Salad	Hispi
PROTEIN / MEAT						
Dry-aged Gooralie pork tomahawk	2 (700 g + 730 g), in hand	all	—	—	—	—
PRODUCE						
Fennel	1 medium (~250 g trimmed)	—	—	—	1	—
Granny Smith apple	1 (~160 g)	—	—	—	1	—
Hispi cabbage	1 small (~500 g)	—	—	—	—	1
Lemon	1 large	—	—	—	20 ml	≤5 ml
Parsley	1 small bunch	—	—	—	15 g	—
Potatoes, floury	600 g peeled (buy ~725 g)	—	—	600 g	—	—
Shallots	90 g	—	70 g	—	20 g	—
Thyme	2 sprigs	—	2	—	—	—
FRIDGE / DAIRY						
Unsalted butter	105 g	—	25 g	80 g	—	—
Whole milk	130 ml	—	—	100 + 30 ml	—	—
OILS & LIQUIDS						
Chicken stock, unsalted	400 ml	—	400 ml	—	—	—
Thatchers Gold cider (medium dry)	250 ml (of a 500 ml bottle)	—	250 ml	—	—	—
Extra-virgin olive oil (pantry check)	~55 ml	—	—	—	30 ml	20 g
Neutral oil (pantry check)	10 g	10 g	—	—	—	—
SEASONING						
Cider vinegar (pantry check)	8 ml	—	8 ml	—	—	—
Diamond Crystal kosher salt (pantry check)	~20 g + to taste	5 g belly (done) + ~6.4 g loin	to taste	4 g	1.5 g	3 g
Black pepper (pantry check)	—	1.5 g	✓	—	✓	✓

Sourcing notes

- One lemon covers both the salad and the hispi.
- Cider: Thatchers Gold is medium dry, not brut, so expect to use all 4 ml of the reserved cider vinegar at the finish.
- Potatoes: Russet, Agria or Maris Piper. Purchase weight allows for peeling; the recipe runs on peeled weight.
- No hispi: Savoy (quarters, same timings), round green cabbage (eighths; rounded side 4–6 min), or tenderstem broccoli (5–7 min, start at E+10).

1. Reverse-Seared Dry-Aged Pork Tomahawk

Yield: 2 loins with bone, belly pieces and crackling; serves 3 · Active: ~40 min · Loin brine: 3 hr same-day; belly: overnight · Low roast: 40–70 min (designed) · Oven: 225°F / 107°C · Leave-in probe in the oven only; Thermapen at the fire

Deep binchotan crust over juicy, faintly pink loin with the dry-aged character leading; crisp-rind belly and crackling alongside.

PORK (SPLIT SATURDAY)	
Loins with rib bone, rind removed, ~5 mm fat, 3.5 cm eye	2 (weigh at 1:45)
Belly pieces (~8 cm) + loin-rind strips (~3 cm)	631 g total
SEASONING	
Diamond Crystal kosher salt, belly + rind (done)	5 g ≈ 1¼ tsp
Diamond Crystal kosher salt, loins	0.8% of loin weight (~6.4 g ≈ 2¼ tsp)
Neutral high-smoke-point oil	10 g / ¾ tbsp
Black pepper, freshly ground	1.5 g / ~¾ tsp

Prep Phase

- Saturday (done):** belly split from each loin along the outer face of the rib, bone left with the loin; rind sliced off the loin fat caps leaving ~5 mm fat. Belly in ~8 cm pieces, rind in ~3 cm strips; 631 g salted with 5 g, rind-up, uncovered overnight on a rack. The butcher's scoring is kept as is — no re-scoring.
- 1:45 — loins:** weigh, salt all surfaces at 0.8%, refrigerate uncovered on a rack for 3 hr.

Active Cooking

Crackling (optional, 4:00)

- Rind strips into cold cast iron on outdoor burner 3. Render over medium-low, then raise the heat until the skin blisters. Stop on sight and sound: blistered, glassy skin, fat rendered out — no temperature target (15–25 min, designed).
- Pour the rendered fat into a heatproof bowl for the belly. Hold the crackling on a rack; it goes into the oven with the pork at 4:45.

Loin and belly

- Preheat the oven to 225°F / 107°C at 4:15. At 4:45, once it reads temperature, pat the loins and belly dry and set them on a rack over a tray, fridge-cold, with the crackling alongside.
- Insert the leave-in probe sideways into the centre of a loin eye, clear of bone and fat seams. Set the alarm at 127°F / 53°C.
- Pull the loins at 130°F / 54°C (E+0, reading #1).** Expected finish 145–150°F / 63–66°C; rise +15 to +20°F (designed, not validated). Record total oven time. The belly comes out at the same time.
- Rest the loins uncovered on a clean rack with the probe still in, 8 min. At E+8, log reading #2 and remove the probe before the binchotan.
- Reading #2 gate (designed thresholds):** below 136°F / 58°C — normal colour-led sear with fat-edge stand; 136–139°F / 58–59°C — sear hard, minimal time between faces, fat-edge stand ≤60 s; 140°F / 60°C or above — maximum heat, shortest sear giving full colour, no fat-edge stand.
- Pat dry, film lightly with the oil (oil the meat, not the grate) and add the pepper. Sear over the hottest binchotan zone in 60–90 s passes per face, plus the fat-edge stand as the gate allows. Stop on colour: deep mahogany across both faces. Record contact time. Thermapen the centre (reading #3).
- Belly, from E+0:** cast iron on burner 3 over medium with the reserved fat, rind-down, pressed flat under a heavy pan for the first 3–4 min; use a splatter guard. Stop when the rind is blistered, puffed and glassy-crisp, then give the other faces 1–2 min to colour (12–18 min, designed). Thermapen the meat to ≥145°F / 63°C; hold on a rack.

Holding & Assembly

- Rest the loins uncovered on a rack, ≥4 min, so the crust does not steam.
- E+18, reading #4 (Thermapen) plus plate temperature.** Safety floor: ≥145°F / 63°C with a 3-min rest — the safety requirement, separate from the culinary target.
- Carve the loin off the bone, across the grain, 8–10 mm / ½–¾ in thick. Slice the belly across into 1.5–2 cm pieces and set them rind-up beside the loin with the crackling. Jus around the loin, never over the crust, belly or crackling.

Critical Control Points

Class	Failure Mode	Sensory Cue	Recovery
Major	Loin below the safety floor	Reading #4 under 145°F / 63°C	Binchotan edge 60 s per side, rest 3 min, recheck
Major	Missed pull	Probe past 135°F / 57°C at exit	One colour-only pass. Above 150°F finish: unrecoverable for juiciness; serve extra jus
Major	Grey crust	No mahogany after the first pass	Pat dry, hottest zone, second short pass
Major	Belly rind not puffed	Rind still flat and leathery at E+18	Serve the loin; 2–3 more min over higher heat and send the belly after
Minor	Crackling stays leathery	No blistering after 25 min	Raise the heat 5 min; if still leathery, drop it (optional component)

Adjust: salt is weight-controlled — do not season carved slices; add jus instead. If the plate reads too rich, correct the acid in the jus, not on the meat.

Cook log

#	Observation	Instrument	When
—	Loin-eye thickness (3.5 cm recorded)	Ruler	Saturday
—	Salting: loin 3 hr same-day; belly overnight	—	Record actual times
—	Total oven time, entry to pull	Clock	E+0
1	Pull temperature (target 130°F / 54°C)	Probe	E+0
2	End of pre-sear rest	Probe, then remove	E+8
—	Sear contact time, first to last pass	Clock	E+8 → sear stop
3	Sear stop	Thermapen, centre	Immediately after sear
4	After rest (must be ≥145°F / 63°C)	Thermapen	≥4 min rest, E+18
—	Plate temperature	Thermapen, surface	With #4
—	Belly crisp time; crackling time	Clock	At each stop

#2 – #1 = pre-sear drift · #3 – #2 = sear gain · #4 – #3 = carryover.

2. Sharp Cider–Shallot Jus

Yield: ~220 ml / 7½ fl oz · Total: ~50 min · Active: ~20 min · Made at 2:30, chilled, rewarmed at E+0

A lean, glossy jus built independently of the roasting tray: cider for depth, cider vinegar staged for edge.

Shallots, peeled, finely sliced	70 g / 2½ oz
Unsalted butter, to sweat	10 g / ¾ tbsp
Unsalted butter, cold, to finish	15 g / 1 tbsp
Thatchers Gold cider (medium dry)	250 ml / 1 cup
Chicken stock, unsalted or lightly salted	400 ml / 1⅔ cups
Thyme	2 sprigs
Cider vinegar	4 ml + 4 ml held in reserve
Diamond Crystal kosher salt, black pepper	to taste at the end

Prep Phase

1. Measure the cider and stock separately. Set aside the reserved 4 ml vinegar — it is not used until service.

Active Cooking

2. Sweat the shallots in 10 g butter with a pinch of salt over medium-low, 6–8 min. Stop when translucent, without colour.
3. Add the cider and thyme over medium-high. Reduce to ~80 ml / ⅓ cup, until the raw alcohol smell has gone (10–15 min).
4. Add the stock and 4 ml vinegar. Reduce over medium-high to ~220 ml. Stop when it lightly coats a spoon.
5. Strain. Cool in a shallow container and refrigerate by 3:30.

Holding & Assembly

6. E+0: rewarm over very low heat until steaming. Do not boil.
7. E+16: off heat, whisk in the 15 g cold butter.
8. E+18: once the loin is carved, taste against an end slice. The medium-dry cider means you will likely need all of the reserved vinegar: add it 1 ml / ¼ tsp at a time, then salt and pepper.

Critical Control Points

Class	Failure Mode	Sensory Cue	Recovery
Major	Over-reduced	Syrupy or sticky; heavy coat on the spoon	Thin with unsalted stock, 15 ml / 1 tbsp at a time
Major	Reads sweet	Sweet rather than savoury-sharp against the pork	Reserved vinegar in steps; do not mask with salt

Adjust: too sharp — whisk in 5–10 g cold butter. Too salty — dilute with unsalted stock.

3. Potato Purée

Yield: modest adult portions, larger portion for Lukas · Total: ~40 min · Active: ~20 min · Tiger Keep Warm from 5:20

Silky, neutral potato purée; the crust, crackling, raw fennel and charred hispi supply the contrast.

Floury potatoes (Russet, Agria or Maris Piper), peeled, 3 cm pieces	600 g / 1 lb 5 oz
Unsalted butter	80 g / 5½ tbsp
Whole milk	100 ml + 30 ml in reserve
Diamond Crystal kosher salt	4 g ≈ 1½ tsp, plus correction

Prep Phase

1. Peel and cut the potatoes; keep them under cold water until cooking.

Active Cooking

2. 4:40: cover with cold water by 2–3 cm, add the salt, bring to a boil, then simmer over medium-low. Stop when a knife passes through the centre with no resistance (15–20 min).
3. Drain well. Return to the hot pan over low heat for 1–2 min, shaking, until the steam visibly drops.
4. Rice while hot. Warm the milk and butter together until the butter melts, without boiling. Fold in over three additions; stop as soon as it is smooth.

Holding & Assembly

5. 5:20: into the Tiger on Keep Warm. Planned maximum hold 60 min (designed); expected hold 25–55 min.
6. Contingency trigger — 20 min before the ceiling (6:00): if the loin is still in the oven, take the purée out of the Tiger and cover it; at E+10, reheat over low heat on induction 2 with warm milk, 10 ml at a time.
7. E+15: if tightened, fold in reserved warm milk 10 ml / 2 tsp at a time. Taste; correct salt.

Critical Control Points

Class	Failure Mode	Sensory Cue	Recovery
Major	Gluey purée	Elastic or stringy when folded	Unrecoverable for texture; dish remains serviceable
Major	Watery purée	Riced potato weeps liquid	Dry over low heat before adding dairy

Adjust: if it reads heavy, loosen with milk rather than more butter.

4. Shaved Fennel & Granny Smith Salad

Serves 3 · Active: 10–12 min · Prep 5:05; dress at E+10

Cold, crisp and deliberately tart — the palate reset against the pork.

Fennel, trimmed, bruised outer layer removed	1 medium (~250 g / 9 oz)
Granny Smith apple, unpeeled (colour and bite)	1 (~160 g / 5½ oz)
Shallot, paper-thin	20 g / ¾ oz
Parsley leaves	15 g / ½ oz
Lemon juice	20 ml / 1 tbsp + 1 tsp
Extra-virgin olive oil	30 ml / 2 tbsp
Diamond Crystal kosher salt	1.5 g ≈ ½ tsp
Black pepper	to taste

Prep Phase

- 5:05: shave the fennel 1–2 mm on a mandoline; slice the shallot equally thin.
- Whisk the lemon juice, oil and salt. Chill the vegetables and dressing separately, undressed.

Active Cooking

None — no-cook salad.

Holding & Assembly

- E+10: core the apple and cut into matchsticks. Toss fennel, apple and shallot with ~¾ of the dressing; add the parsley.
- Taste against a bite of the pork; add the rest of the dressing only if needed. Hold ≤10 min.

Critical Control Points

Class	Failure Mode	Sensory Cue	Recovery
Major	Collapsed salad	Fennel limp; liquid pooling in the bowl	Unrecoverable for texture; drain and serve

Adjust: too sharp — add 5 ml olive oil.

5. Charred Hispi Cabbage

Serves 3 · Total: ~15 min · Active: ~12 min · Cast iron, outdoor gas burner 1, from E+3

Deep char with slight bitterness over a tender-crisp core — the hot vegetable and smoky counterpoint.

Hispi (pointed) cabbage; sound outer leaves left on to protect the core and take the char	1 small (~500 g / 1 lb)
Extra-virgin olive oil	20 g / 1½ tbsp
Diamond Crystal kosher salt	3 g ≈ 1 tsp
Black pepper	to taste
Lemon juice, held in reserve	up to 5 ml / 1 tsp

Prep Phase

1. 4:55: quarter lengthwise through the core; oil and salt the cut faces.

Active Cooking

2. E+3: heat the cast iron on high. Cut-face down under light spatula pressure, 3–5 min, until deeply browned with black patches.
3. Second cut face, 3–4 min.
4. Rounded side over medium-low, 3–5 min. Stop when a thin knife meets moderate resistance at the thickest stem.

Holding & Assembly

5. Hold uncovered and warm, up to 10 min (expected 3–8 min).
6. At plating, taste beside the pork and jus; add lemon only if it reads flat.

Critical Control Points

Class	Failure Mode	Sensory Cue	Recovery
Major	Burns before the core softens	Surface acrid while the stem is still hard	Drop to medium-low; finish on the rounded side
Major	Soft throughout	Knife meets no resistance at the core	Unrecoverable for texture; dish remains serviceable

Adjust: a few drops of lemon sharpen heavy-char bitterness; do not add sweetness. Substitutes: Savoy quarters (same timings); round green cabbage in eighths (rounded side 4–6 min); tenderstem broccoli (5–7 min, start at E+10).